

# Exporting U.S. Cookies to Argentina

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Course IBM4141  
International Marketing

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# Introduction” What Our Project Explores

- We Explored Whether U.S. cookies with dulce de leche and chocolate can succeed in Argentina.
- We analyzed the industry, culture, economics, politics, market entry, and segmentation.
- Our large-scale trend: Growing Global Middle Class.



# Product and Industry Overview

**Product:** American-style cookies infused with dulce de leche, a culturally loved flavor.

## Industry Insight:

- Argentina: Strong snack culture
- Cookies: daily consumption, especially during mate, school, soccer and family time



# Why Argentina?

## Key Reasons:

- 3rd largest economy in Latin America
- Highly urban (Buenos Aires, Cordoba, Rosario)
- Consumers love sweet snacks
- But inflation + import controls create challenges



# Large-Scale Trend: Growing Global Middle Class

## Why this trend matters:

- Growing middle class= more demand for branded snacks
- Consumers “trade up” premium treats.
- In Argentina even with inflation, people continue to buy affordable indulgence (cookies)



# Culture

## Key cultural Insights:

- Culture= learned behaviors, rituals, values
- Argentina: Family-centered, collectivist, high uncertainty avoidance.
- Snacks are for sharing social rituals.
- Dulce de leche flavor + Spanish packaging fits cultural expectations



# Political Environment

## Political Reality:

- Democratic republic
- Import restrictions, tariffs, licensing
- Currency controls
- But tax incentives for local production

## Impact on Success:

- Short term challenges
- Long Term opportunity if we partner locally.



# Economic and Trade Insights

## Challenges:

- Inflation
- Exchange-rate volatility
- Tariffs increasing cost of imported snacks

## Opportunities:

- Snack demand stays strong
- MERCOSUR membership → regional expansion +lower costs if produced locally



# Target Segments

1. Urban Middle- Class Families (Primary Segment)
2. Young Adults and University Students.
3. Health-Conscious Professionals.

## Why these work:

- They reflect cultural values, lifestyle, and price sensitivity
- They are the highest snack consumers.



# Positioning Strategy

## Value Proposition:

“A premium American cookie blended with Argentina’s favorite flavors a treat to share during everyday moments”

## Differentiation:

- Chocolate + dulce de leche fusion
- Softer, bakery style texture
- Premium yet affordable
- Emotional connection (family + tradition)



# Market Entry strategy

## Recommended Entry Mode:

Joint Venture with local manufacturer

- Cuts imports costs
- Helps navigate regulations
- Builds brand trust
- Gives access to MERCOSUR (Regional expansion)

**Short-term:** Import specialty batches

**Long-Term:** Local production + regional scaling



# Final Insights and story Ending

## Overall Conclusion:

- Argentina is culturally aligned with our product
- Economic + political barriers exist but are manageable
- Growing middle class + strong snack culture → high long-term potential
- Joint venture entry + localized flavor= best chance for success

## Closing Message:

“Our product fits Argentina not just in taste, but in culture”

